

Varun

Cultural insights / Brand strategy / Articulation

[LinkedIn](#) · [Selected work](#)

Cultural insights and brand strategist with a particular strength in articulation: turning cultural understanding into a clear point of view, a useful brief and language that guides the work. Currently at District; previously led Kommune's consultancy division. Published work examines how identity, technology and social context shape what people consume and how they spend their time.

Professional experience

District | Brand strategy · Current

Work on brand strategy for the going-out platform, with a focus on the cultural and social meanings of experiences. Authored *Touching Grass: How India Will Go Out in 2026*.

Kommune and Stumble | Culture, strategy and partnerships · Previously

Led Kommune's consultancy division and managed Stumble, its culture-focused online magazine. Work brought cultural interpretation into brand strategy, partnerships and editorial projects.

Selected brand experience Coca-Cola, Spotify, Netflix, Diageo, Meta and Bumble.

Selected research and publishing

Consumed | Co-author with Ria Chopra · Stumble × Kommune · 2024

A deep dive into consumer culture in India, informed by more than 100 expert perspectives across 17 sectors. Explores the tensions shaping consumption, media and identity.

Breaking Western Narratives | Interview contributor with Ria Chopra · 2025

Featured in Hannah Grey's *Cultural Vibrations: Shifting Ground*. Discussed the assumptions behind global consumer narratives and the specificity of Indian cultural experience.

Uncultured by Stumble | Podcast co-host with Ria Chopra

Conversations on Indian popular culture, technology, consumption and online behaviour.

Advisory and public conversations

Contributed to Google's AI and culture advisory panel via Canvas8. Moderated culture panels at Brand & Entertainment, Under 25 Summit, CultureCon, All About Music, IIMW and other conferences.

Education

Young India Fellowship, Ashoka University | Class of 2021

Computer Science Engineering, BNM Institute of Technology, Bengaluru